

Tir Na Beatha: Mysteries of the Hidden Citadel

January 30, 2026 - Session 5

Outline

Departure from Cleverclaw

- The party prepared to leave the inn in Cleverclaw.
- Exploder learned about safe waterways for travel.
- Mage Armor was cast before departure.

Encounter in the Forest

- The party was surrounded by a shimmering presence.
- Themaer Eagerflower interacted with a Fairy Dragon and exchanged a story for knots.
- The Fairy Dragon gifted a Scroll of Comprehend Languages.

Exploration of the Hidden Citadel

- The party discovered the Hidden Citadel and assessed the tower's condition.
- They found a Laboratory with strange lights and chemical labels.
- An Animated Armor attacked them in the Armory, but they defeated it.

Gremlins and Treasure Discovery

- The party freed three gremlins from glass tubes.
- The gremlins provided information about a previous visitor.
- They located a treasure cache in the forest and divided the spoils.

Session Summary

The party departed from the Wellandrym Vale after a stay at the inn in Cleverclaw. They traveled upstream on Cleverclaw Creek with the assistance of a Triton Boatman and encountered a shimmering presence in the forest before Themaer Eagerflower had a playful interaction with a Fairy Dragon, who returned stolen knots and gifted a Scroll of Comprehend Languages.

Upon discovering the Hidden Citadel, the group explored the ruins, including a tower filled with expired bird feed and a Laboratory with strange lights and chemical labels. They uncovered a Security Panel and activated cleaning drones, learning about the panel's purpose related to experimentation.

In the Armory, they triggered an Animated Armor that attacked the party, but they successfully defeated it. They then found an office with a glowing tablet that discussed consciousness and a figure named "Elizabeth." After climbing to the third level, they encountered gremlins trapped in glass tubes, which they freed. The gremlins revealed that a tall figure had visited previously and taken something from the central Cube-Within-A-Cube.

The party located a hidden cache in the forest containing valuable items, including Starfire Rhapsody Wine and a Cloak of Billowing. They divided the treasure and decided to return to camp for rest before continuing their exploration and reporting on their findings at the Hidden Citadel.

MOMENT

The Final Blow to the Animated Armor

Koldea strikes the Animated Armor's knee with her Morningstar, sending metal shards flying. Themaer channels divine energy, unleashing a Sacred Flame that scorches the armor. Exploder retaliates with Magic Missiles as the armor swings at him. Koldea delivers another blow, and Themaer's final Sacred Flame reduces the armor to a lifeless heap. Together, they can bring down even the toughest foes.

MOMENT

Exploring the Pristine Laboratory

The party entered a sterile 30×35-foot Laboratory, lit by eerie lights. A dissection table dominated the center, surrounded by crates and desks, while glass cases displayed curious components. Koldea approached the table, intrigued, as Exploder signaled the others to stay alert. The pristine environment contrasted sharply with the turmoil outside, prompting thoughts of the dark secrets hidden within. What horrors were once studied here?

MOMENT

Themaer Eagerflower's Bargain with a Fairy Dragon

Themaer Eagerflower rushed to join his companions when a Fairy Dragon landed nearby, holding three stolen knots. After listening to their story about outsmarting a goblin for mushrooms, it returned the knots and gifted Themaer a stolen scroll. As the dragon disappeared in smoke, Themaer felt triumph and wonder at the whimsical exchange.

Confrontation with Animated Armor

- The party entered the Armory and triggered an Animated Armor.
- Koldea and Exploder attempted to attack but faced difficulties.
- Themaer Eagerflower cast Sacred Flame, damaging the armor significantly.
- The party ultimately defeated the armor after a series of attacks.

Rescue of the Gremlins

- The party discovered three gremlins trapped in glass tubes on the third floor.
- Exploder broke the first tube with a Fire Bolt, freeing a gremlin.
- The party cooperatively freed the second and third gremlins from their tubes.
- The gremlins expressed gratitude and shared information about a past visitor.

Key Entities

Cleverclaw Creek: The party traveled upstream on the western branch of Cleverclaw Creek with a Triton Boatman.

Fairy Dragon: The Fairy Dragon confronted Themaer Eagerflower, taunted the party, and returned stolen knots.

Animated Armor: The Animated Armor attacked the party when they entered the Armory.

Hidden Citadel: The party discovered the ruins of the Hidden Citadel, which included three blue-roofed stone buildings.

Laboratory: The party explored a Laboratory with strange lights and chemical labels.

Gremlins: The three gremlins, Jonathan, Taylor, and Thomas, were freed from glass tubes and provided information about a past visitor.

Exploder

The mimic-voiced avian sorcerer cast Mage Armor on himself and used sorcery points to recover an expended spell slot. He also engaged in combat against the Animated Armor and later examined the Cube-Within-A-Cube.

- Cast Mage Armor before departure.
- Fired multiple spells during the battle with the Animated Armor.

Koldea

The stalwart melee fighter led the party through the exploration of the Hidden Citadel and engaged in combat with the Animated Armor. He also assisted in freeing the gremlins from their tubes.

- Led the party during their exploration.
- Successfully struck the Animated Armor during combat.

Themaer Eagerflower

The furbolg with nature and craft skills interacted with the Fairy Dragon and successfully bartered for the return of stolen knots. He also read the glowing tablet and deciphered chemical labels in the Laboratory.

- Bartered with the Fairy Dragon for the return of knots.
- Used the Scroll of Comprehend Languages to read chemical labels.

NOTABLE ITEMS

Item	Description
Scroll of Comprehend Languages	The Scroll of Comprehend Languages was gifted to Themaer Eagerflower by the Fairy Dragon.
Cube-Within-A-Cube	The Cube-Within-A-Cube levitated above a stone pedestal on the third floor, with its force sustaining it weakened.
Cloak of Billowing	The Cloak of Billowing was found in the forest cache and can billow on command.
Starfire Rhapsody Wine	Three bottles of Starfire Rhapsody Wine were discovered in the forest cache, each worth 25 square knots.
Potion of Healing	Two potions of healing were found in the forest cache, useful for restoring health.

Valuable Information

1. The party learned that waterways like Cleverclaw Creek are the safest routes in Tir Na Beatha.
2. The Fairy Dragon was interested in stories and returned stolen knots after hearing one from Themaer Eagerflower.
3. The Security Panel in the Laboratory was identified as related to experimentation and electromagnetic energy.
4. The gremlins revealed that a tall figure with long autumn hair visited the site four months prior.
5. The glowing tablet discussed consciousness being detectable and alterable by a device.
6. The gremlins indicated that lightning storms are drawn to the site of the Hidden Citadel.
7. The Cube-Within-A-Cube was found to be noninteractive and lacked a magical aura.

Party Status

The party is currently in the Hidden Citadel, having explored several buildings and encountered various entities. They are in good condition after defeating the Animated Armor and freeing the gremlins.

- Exploder has one Potion of Healing and the Cloak of Billowing.
- Koldea possesses the Scroll of Shield for combat use.
- The party has gathered valuable information and treasure from the forest cache.

Next Steps

The party plans to return by the safest route, set up camp, and resume exploration after resting.